

[object Object]

I used to feel like I was faking it every time I showed up as the energetic, visible version of myself at work.

I am naturally introverted. Groups cost me energy. So when I had to lead a meeting, give a presentation, or hold a room — and I pulled it off — I felt like it was not really me.

Here is what I had to learn the hard way: that feeling is not inauthenticity.

Authenticity is not about being who you are. It is about showing up how you want others to see you.

The version of me that leads well is not a mask. It is a version of me I practiced until it became natural.

You do not have to be yourself at work. You have to be intentional.

If you feel like you are performing at work, you might just be learning a skill.

[PAUSE — let that land]

What version of yourself do you want to be practicing?

- **Delivery notes:**
- Slower pace on "Authenticity is not about being who you are." Let it sit.
- "It is about showing up how you want others to see you." — slight lean forward.
- "You do not have to be yourself at work. You have to be intentional." — let this land as its own moment.
- Conversational throughout. This is not a lecture. It is a thought shared at eye level.
- No script visible. Know this cold before recording.

[object Object] The feeling of "faking it" at work might not be inauthenticity. It might be a skill you are still learning.

#leadership #leadershipdevelopment #techleadership #authenticity #leadershipcoach #introverts #careergrowth #intentionallyleadership